

United Nations Votes

My first Quarto file

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Introduction

How do various countries vote in the United Nations General Assembly, how have their voting patterns evolved throughout time, and how similarly or differently do they view certain issues? Answering these questions (at a high level) is the focus of this analysis.

Packages

We will use the **tidyverse**, **lubridate**, and **scales** packages for data wrangling and visualization, and the **DT** package for interactive display of tabular output, and the **unvotes** package for the data.

```
library(tidyverse)
library(lubridate)
library(scales)
library(DT)
library(unvotes)
```

Data

The data we're using originally come from the **unvotes** package. In the chunk below we modify the data by joining the various data frames provided in the package to help you get started with the analysis.

```
unv <- unvotes::un_votes %>%
  inner_join(un_roll_calls, by = "rcid") %>%
  inner_join(un_roll_call_issues, by = "rcid")
```

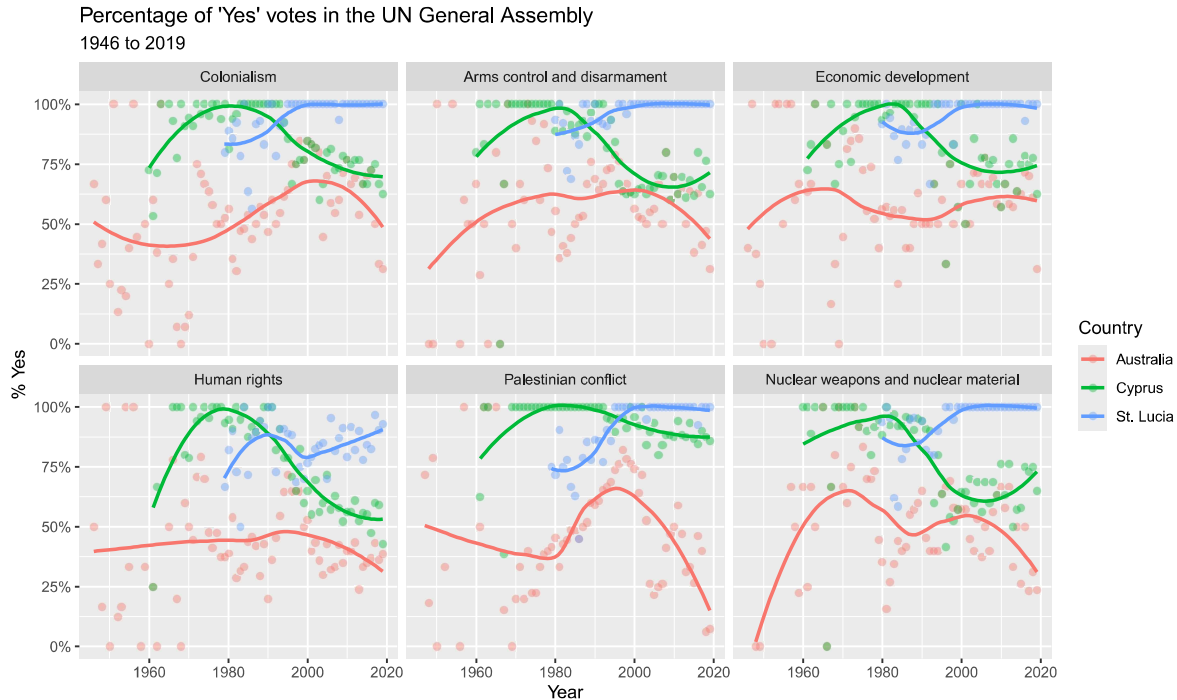
UN voting patterns

Let's create a data visualisation that displays how the voting record of the UK & NI changed over time on a variety of issues, and compares it to two other countries: US and Turkey.

```
unv %>%
  filter(country %in% c("Australia", "Cyprus", "St. Lucia")) %>%
  mutate(year = year(date)) %>%
  group_by(country, year, issue) %>%
  summarize(percent_yes = mean(vote == "yes")) %>%
  ggplot(mapping = aes(x = year, y = percent_yes, color = country)) +
  geom_point(alpha = 0.4) +
  geom_smooth(method = "loess", se = FALSE) +
  facet_wrap(~issue) +
  scale_y_continuous(labels = percent) +
  labs(
    title = "Percentage of 'Yes' votes in the UN General Assembly",
    subtitle = "1946 to 2019",
    y = "% Yes",
    x = "Year",
    color = "Country"
  )
```

``summarise()`` has grouped output by 'country', 'year'. You can override using the ``.groups`` argument.

``geom_smooth()`` using formula = 'y ~ x'



1. Write 1-2 sentences here about what you learned from these plots

The UK seems to be a lot more moderate in these issues always falling in between the USA and Turkey. Also Human Rights and Gun Control seem to be the topics with most similar voting patterns as seen that the difference in the ending yes votes are the most concentrated.

We can easily change which countries are being plotted by changing which countries the code above `filters` for. Note that the country name should be spelled and capitalized exactly the same way as it appears in the data. See the Appendix for a list of the countries in the data.

2. Customize the plot Choose different countries to explore. Copy the entire code chunk from above to below this line, edit the countries and re-render. Write a few sentences comparing these countries to the ones above.

I compared Australia, Cyprus, and St. Lucia. Looking at these countries I see that St Lucia almost always votes yes on every topic except human rights as their line is a steady line on the top of the board. This used to be the case with Cyprus as well but since 1980-1990 their overall yes votes have trended down across the board on all topics but the least affected was the Palestine Conflict.

References

1. David Robinson (2017). [unvotes](#): United Nations General Assembly Voting Data. R package version 0.2.0.
2. Erik Voeten “Data and Analyses of Voting in the UN General Assembly” Routledge Handbook of International Organization, edited by Bob Reinalda (published May 27, 2013).
3. Much of the analysis has been modeled on the examples presented in the [unvotes package vignette](#).